

Learning Goals for Test 1 (26.02.2026)

Grammar: all the material in this Unit 3/ Grammar is relevant for the preparation of the test! You need to:

1. know what Reported/Indirect Speech is and which changes need to be made when transforming Direct Speech to Reported/Indirect Speech.
2. Consider specifically the following aspects: tense backshift, personal pronouns, time and place references.

Vocabulary:

1. You understand and can use the following vocabulary Unit 3/Vocabulary in context: vocabulary on pages 2-3, including the quizlet.
- You are expected to be able to transfer your knowledge and expertise in grammar and vocabulary and apply it correctly in new contexts.
 - There will be a listening comprehension exercise and a reading comprehension exercise in the test.

1. Reported / indirect speech

What is Reported Speech?

Reported (Indirect) Speech is used to report what someone said without repeating the exact words.

Direct Speech:

- She said: "I am tired."

Reported Speech:

- She said that she was tired.

2. Tense backshift

When the reporting verb is in the past (e.g. said, told), the tense usually moves one step back in time.

PHRASE IN DIRECT SPEECH	EQUIVALENT IN REPORTED SPEECH
Simple present "I always <i>drink</i> coffee", she said	Simple past She said that she always <i>drank</i> coffee.
Present continuous "I <i>am reading</i> a book", he explained.	Past continuous He explained that he <i>was reading</i> a book
Simple past "Bill <i>arrived</i> on Saturday", he said.	Past perfect He said that Bill <i>had arrived</i> on Saturday.
Present perfect "I <i>have been</i> to Spain", he told me.	Past perfect He told me that he <i>had been</i> to Spain.
Past perfect "I <i>had just turned out</i> the light," he explained.	Past perfect He explained that he <i>had just turned out</i> the light.
Present perfect continuous They complained, "We <i>have been waiting</i> for hours".	Past perfect continuous They complained that they <i>had been waiting</i> for hours.
Past continuous "We <i>were living</i> in Paris", they told me.	Past perfect continuous They told me that they <i>had been living</i> in Paris.
Future "I <i>will be</i> in Geneva on Monday", he said.	Present conditional He said that he <i>would be</i> in Geneva on Monday.

Examples:

"I am reading." → She said she was reading.

"I went home." → He said he had gone home.

"I will call you." → She said she would call me.

"I can swim." → He said he could swim.

No tense change if:

- The reporting verb is in the present (e.g. says, tells)
- The statement is still true

Example:

- He says he likes coffee.

3. Personal pronoun changes

Pronouns often change depending on the perspective.

I → he / she

me → him / her

my → his / her

we → they

our → their

you → I / we / they (depending on context)

Example:

"I like your car."

He said he liked her car.

4. Time and place references

Direct	Reported
today	that day
yesterday	the day before
tomorrow	the next day / the following day
next week	the following week
last week	the previous week
ago	before
here	there
this	that

Example:

“I saw her yesterday.”

He said he had seen her the day before.

5. Reported questions

In reported questions:

- Word order becomes normal sentence order
- No do / does / did
- No question mark
- Yes/No questions use if or whether

Direct:

“Where do you live?”

Reported:

He asked where I lived.

Direct:

“Are you tired?”

Reported:

She asked if I was tired.

6. Reported commands and requests

Structure:

tell / ask + object + to + infinitive

tell / ask + object + not to + infinitive

“Close the door.”

He told me to close the door.

“Don’t cheat.”

She told him not to cheat.

7. Important reporting verbs

Besides say and tell, you should know:

- explain
- promise
- admit
- suggest
- offer
- warn
- advise
- complain
- persuade
- insist

Example:

“I will help you.”

She promised to help me.

8.Vocabulary**General School Vocabulary**

detention – Nachsitzen
 educational – lehrreich
 academic – akademisch
 misbehave – sich danebenbenehmen
 behave – sich benehmen, sich verhalten
 punish – bestrafen
 expel – von der Schule verweisen
 discipline – Disziplin
 bullying – Mobbing
 curriculum – Lehrplan
 subject – Schulfach
 topic – Thema
 term – Semester, Trimester
 timetable – Stundenplan
 assembly – Schulversammlung, Aula
 library – Bibliothek
 head teacher – Schulleiter
 pupils – Schüler
 nursery – Kindertagesstätte

School System

primary school – Primarschule
 secondary school – Sekundarschule
 state school – staatliche Schule
 private school – Privatschule
 boarding school – Internat
 vocational school – berufliche Schule
 compulsory – obligatorisch
 education – Bildung
 training – Ausbildung, Schulung
 career – Karriere

Exams and Assessment

exam – Prüfung
 exams – Prüfungen
 mock exam – Probeproofung
 assessment – Beurteilung
 marks – Schulnoten (BE)
 grades – Noten (AE)
 reports – Zeugnisse, Berichte
 pass – bestehen
 fail – durchfallen
 revise – wiederholen, lernen
 revision – Wiederholung
 cram – pauken
 learn by heart – auswendig lernen
 cheat – schummeln
 hand in – abgeben
 assignment – Aufgabe, Auftrag
 coursework – schriftliche oder praktische Leistung
 innerhalb eines Schuljahres
 essay – Aufsatz
 take notes – sich Notizen machen
 pay attention to – aufpassen

Education Verbs

qualify – sich qualifizieren
 graduate (from) – abschliessen
 drop out (of school) – die Schule abbrechen
 revise – wiederholen
 cheat – schummeln
 enroll (in) – sich einschreiben
 hand in – abgeben

Higher Education

university – Universität
 degree – Abschluss, akademischer Grad
 graduate – Absolvent/in
 A-levels – britische Maturaprüfung
 qualification – Qualifikation
 skills – Fähigkeiten, Fertigkeiten
 scholarship – Stipendium
 student loan – Studentendarlehen
 tuition fee – Studiengebühr
 enroll – einschreiben, anmelden
 lecture – Vorlesung
 tutor – Nachhilfelehrer/in, Privatlehrer/in

Reading Vocabulary

infamous – berüchtigt
 prestigious – angesehen, renommiert
 revision – Wiederholung
 mock exam – Probeproofung
 job prospects – Berufsaussichten
 to cram – pauken

Learning & Challenges

challenge – Herausforderung
 majority – Mehrheit
 strict – streng, strikt
 achievement gap – Leistungsgefälle
 keep up with sb/sth – mit jmdm./etw. mithalten können
 fall behind – zurückfallen, in Rückstand geraten
 procrastinate – Dinge aufschieben
 take part in – sich beteiligen an
 participate – teilnehmen
 internship – Praktikum
 apprenticeship – Ausbildung, Lehre

Financial & School Organisation

fees – Gebühren
 tuition fee – Studiengebühr
 loan – Darlehen
 student loan – Studentendarlehen

Collocations

make a decision – eine Entscheidung treffen
 make a choice – eine Wahl treffen
 make a plan – einen Plan machen
 make a mistake – einen Fehler machen
 make a promise – ein Versprechen machen
 make an effort – sich bemühen
 make progress – Fortschritte machen
 make money – Geld verdienen
 do homework – Hausaufgaben machen
 do an exam – eine Prüfung ablegen
 do business – Geschäfte machen
 do chores – Hausarbeiten machen
 do the shopping – einkaufen gehen
 do the washing – Wäsche machen
 do sport – Sport treiben
 do your best – dein Bestes geben
 do well – erfolgreich sein